

limited device compatibility and screen variations, so it is easier to build an app which is compatible enough to run on several devices.

Build desktop applications with Visual Basic

For interacting with the desktop environment, Visual Basic and VBScript are what people have been using for years, but their limitation is that they lack fancy user interfaces. Recently, Python and Ruby have evolved as powerful yet compatible programming languages for desktop application development.

Learn basic coding with Scratch

If you don't want to be bothered with serious programming terms and concepts before creating something relevant, then you should start with the Scratch tool. This was first introduced in the US and, in the classroom, kids were engaged to teach code. The use of zombies, the Angry Birds and other cartoon characters has made it more entertaining and motivating to code. The tool is a simple plug-and-play utility with predefined behaviour, and you need to assemble it to get the behaviour required.

Figure 2 gives the statistics of the popularity of various programming languages among the user community (source: LinkedIn.com).

Although it is said that you don't need to have any project in mind before learning programming, the truth is that if you are working on an actual project, you will be more motivated

Table 2

Language	Popular compilers
PHP	Wamp, Zamp, Lamp
Java	NetBeans, Eclipse
Python	PyCharm
Ruby	ColdRuby

to learn programming in order to achieve the desired goal. If you have certain requirements beforehand, then you can easily correlate them with the learning environment and work towards what needs to be accomplished.

Talking about compilers

Every code is incomplete without being compiled to give you the desired output. The compiler changes the lines of code into useful and meaningful output. Different languages use different compilers to suit and support their environment. Shown in Table 2 are the popular compilers for open source programming languages. 

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```
19:37 <mbuf>      rtnpro, 1. Need to install "ecb" from your
distro package manager
19:37 <mbuf>      2. you could have searched this on the Internet :)
19:38 <rtnpro>      It is not in my distro
19:38 <sumitc>      !
19:38 <mbuf>      rtnpro, and which distro are you using?
19:38 <rtnpro>      Its Fedora 9
19:39 <rtnpro>      I have got emacs but not emacs code browser
19:39 <mbuf>      rtnpro, you can always install from source
19:39 <techno_freak> rtnpro, http://ecb.sourceforge.net/downloads.html
19:39 *** khushbu QUIT Ping timeout: 244 seconds
19:39 <rtnpro>      ok
19:39 <mbuf>      sumitc, shoot!
19:39 <sumitc>      what is a tag-file?
19:40 <rtnpro>      What factors should decide the choice of our
editor?
19:40 <mbuf>      rtnpro, wait!
19:40 *** pushkal JOIN
19:40 <mbuf>      sumitc, the TAGS file contains the details of
the reference count,
and locations of variables/functions et. al.
```

```
19:41 <sumitc>      So, a tag file is always associated with a
specific file?
19:41 <mbuf>      sumitc, no, it can have information of files
in a directory
19:41 <sumitc>      ok
19:41 <sumitc>      <eof>
19:42 <mbuf>      sumitc, think of it as a database that
answers all your queries
regarding code references
```



References

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